

SEVEN QUESTIONS ABOUT GETTING MORE VALUE FROM THE STOCK YOU ALREADY HAVE

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Could an independent yard do a little more with what it already has without becoming a factory?

Independent lumberyards already have things that are hard to recreate: stock close to customers, people who know the material, handling equipment, space, contractor relationships, and local pickup and delivery.

I'm studying whether better project information and a small amount of repeatable processing could help some yards capture more of the value in that existing capability.

I'm not here to sell equipment. I want to understand the yard first.

1 — Why do your best customers come here?

When they choose this yard instead of a big box or ordering online, what are they really coming here for besides the material?

2 — What could be doing more for you?

Of what you already have here — stock, people, equipment, space, trucks, material knowledge, customer relationships — what seems capable of doing more for the business than it does today?

3 — Where does value leave the yard?

What do customers ask you to do with material that you currently give away, undercharge for, send somewhere else, or decline?

Think about the last real job where you had the material and the customer, but somebody else captured the higher-value part of the work.

4 — What is one useful step farther?

If you could add one repeatable capability beyond what you already do — not turn the yard into a custom shop, just go one useful step farther — what would actually help you compete or differentiate?

Cutting? Panel sizing? Drilling? Milling? Labeling? Kitting? Something else I haven't thought to ask?

HERE IS THE PART I AM TESTING

Suppose the complicated project definition happens before the order reaches the yard.

The order arrives with dimensions resolved, material and parts identified, labels ready, and the machine instructions already written — limited to the operations the yard has chosen to support.

Nobody at the yard designs the job, and nobody programs the machine. The yard decides what it will accept, and work outside those limits does not run.

Better information first. Material second.

5 — What would you still need to control?

If an order really arrived that complete, what would you still need to check or decide before putting your material, people, equipment, and name behind it?

6 — What would make it worth testing?

What would have to be true for a capability like that to earn its floor space and attention?

7 — Smallest real test

Without buying anything new, what is the smallest real order you would choose to test the idea?

What result would make you want to run a second one?

WHAT I DO WITH YOUR ANSWERS

They go back into the design.

I am looking for where the idea works, where it only works narrowly, and where it does not make sense at all, and honestly, what I should have asked.

A no with a reason is more useful to me than a polite yes.

Nothing to sign. No commitment. No sales follow-up.

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